

The Lives of Animals

"We are not just rather like animals; we are animals. Our difference from other species may be striking, but comparisons with them have always been, and must be, crucial to our view of ourselves."

— MARY MIDGLEY

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

What can we learn about ourselves by observing and interacting with animals?

MAIN SELECTIONS

1 **Willie B.: A Story of Hope** · Nancy Roe Pimm **NARRATIVE NONFICTION**

2 **Dolphin Parenting** · from National Geographic **VIDEO**

3 **Can We Be Friends?** · Ellen R. Braaf **MAGAZINE ARTICLE**

4 **Winter Bees and Other Poems of the Cold** · Joyce Sidman (illus. Rick Allen) **POETRY**

CONTENTS

A · Vocabulary (33)	p. 2
B · Reading Comprehension (32)	p. 6
C · IB Critical Thinking (5)	p. 10
D · MAP Practice (20)	p. 13



Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 10 · The Lives of Animals · Grade 5 · 33 Items

CCSS L.5.4 · L.5.5 · L.5.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

BIG IDEA WORDS

Q1 L.5.6

relationship

A **relationship** is —

- ☐ A. a short argument that quickly ends.
- ☐ B. a single meeting between strangers.
- ☐ C. the way people or animals feel and act toward each other.
- ☐ D. a feeling of being completely alone.

Q2 L.5.5 TRAP

antisocial

If you are feeling **antisocial**, you —

- ☐ A. do not feel like being around other people.
- ☐ B. want to throw a big party with friends.
- ☐ C. enjoy meeting as many people as you can.
- ☐ D. feel friendly and welcoming to everyone.

Q3 L.5.6

bond

People who have a **bond** —

- ☐ A. live very far apart.
- ☐ B. have never met before.
- ☐ C. owe money to a bank.
- ☐ D. feel friendship or love that unites them.

Q4 L.5.6

tension

Tension is —

- ☐ **A.** a feeling of deep rest and calm.
- ☐ **B.** a feeling of stress that a difficult situation can produce.
- ☐ **C.** a feeling of great joy and delight.
- ☐ **D.** a feeling of warm friendship.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · WILLIE B.: A STORY OF HOPE

Q5 L.5.4

enclosure

An **enclosure** is —

- ☐ **A.** an area that is surrounded by a fence or walls.
- ☐ **B.** a wide and open field with no edges.
- ☐ **C.** a letter sent through the mail.
- ☐ **D.** a tall tree in a forest.

Q6 L.5.5 TRAP

anticipation

If you are in **anticipation** of something, you are —

- ☐ **A.** completely surprised that it happened.
- ☐ **B.** trying hard to forget about it.
- ☐ **C.** bored and not thinking about it.
- ☐ **D.** expecting it to happen and excited or anxious about it.

Q7 L.5.4

possession

A **possession** is —

- ☐ **A.** something you have borrowed from a friend.
- ☐ **B.** something you own.
- ☐ **C.** something you have lost for good.
- ☐ **D.** something that belongs to no one.

Q8 L.5.5 TRAP

inhumane

To be **inhumane** is to be —

- ☐ A. kind and gentle to others.
- ☐ B. caring and warm-hearted.
- ☐ C. cruel and unfeeling.
- ☐ D. fair and generous.

Q9 L.5.4

solitary

Someone who is **solitary** is —

- ☐ A. alone.
- ☐ B. in a large crowd.
- ☐ C. surrounded by friends.
- ☐ D. part of a busy group.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · WILLIE B.: A STORY OF HOPE (CONTINUED)

Q10 L.5.4

territory

Territory is —

- ☐ A. a narrow path between two walls.
- ☐ B. an area of land.
- ☐ C. a building where animals are fed.
- ☐ D. a fence around a yard.

Q11 L.5.4

coaxing

If you are **coaxing** someone, you are —

- ☐ A. shouting orders at that person.
- ☐ B. ignoring that person completely.
- ☐ C. racing ahead of that person.
- ☐ D. gently and patiently persuading that person to do something.

Q12 L.5.4

generation

A **generation** is —

- ☐ A. a group of people or animals who are about the same age.
- ☐ B. a single animal living on its own.
- ☐ C. a large family of many different ages.
- ☐ D. a leader who is older than the rest.

Q13 L.5.5 TRAP

dominated

If one animal **dominated** another, it —

- ☐ A. obeyed and followed the other.
- ☐ B. was weaker and gave way to the other.
- ☐ C. was more powerful and controlled what the other did.
- ☐ D. stayed far away from the other.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · DOLPHIN PARENTING

Q14 L.5.4

posture

Posture is —

- ☐ A. the speed at which an animal moves.
- ☐ B. the size and weight of an animal's body.
- ☐ C. the path an animal takes to its home.
- ☐ D. the position of a person's or animal's body.

Q15 L.5.4

master

To **master** an activity is to —

- ☐ A. give it up after trying once.
- ☐ B. learn to do it well.
- ☐ C. teach it only to others.
- ☐ D. watch someone else do it.

Q16 L.5.4

technique

A **technique** is —

- ☐ **A.** a way of making or doing something.
- ☐ **B.** a tool used only once and thrown away.
- ☐ **C.** a mistake that ruins a task.
- ☐ **D.** a rule that must never be broken.

Q17 L.5.4

utilize

To **utilize** something is to —

- ☐ **A.** throw it away.
- ☐ **B.** hide it from others.
- ☐ **C.** use it.
- ☐ **D.** break it apart.

Q18 L.5.4

fend

People and animals that **fend** for themselves —

- ☐ **A.** always need help from others.
- ☐ **B.** survive without help.
- ☐ **C.** give up easily.
- ☐ **D.** follow a leader everywhere.

Q19 L.5.5 TRAP

status

An animal's **status** is —

- ☐ **A.** the place where it sleeps at night.
- ☐ **B.** the kind of food it likes to eat.
- ☐ **C.** the distance it can travel in a day.
- ☐ **D.** the level of importance it has within its social group.

Q20 L.5.5 TRAP

coweredIf an animal **cowered**, it —

- ☐ A. crouched or bent down in fear.
- ☐ B. stood up tall and bravely.
- ☐ C. charged forward without fear.
- ☐ D. rested calmly and peacefully.

Q21 L.5.4

benefitIf you **benefit** from something, it —

- ☐ A. makes your life harder.
- ☐ B. has no effect on you at all.
- ☐ C. makes your life better in some way.
- ☐ D. belongs to someone else.

Q22 L.5.4

clanA **clan** is —

- ☐ A. a single animal living alone.
- ☐ B. a group of animals or people who are usually members of the same family.
- ☐ C. two animals from different families.
- ☐ D. a pair of enemies that avoid each other.

Q23 L.5.5 TRAP

restoreTo **restore** something is to —

- ☐ A. change it back to the way it used to be.
- ☐ B. change it into something completely new.
- ☐ C. break it down for good.
- ☐ D. leave it exactly as it is now.

Q24 L.5.5 TRAP

reconcile

If you **reconcile** with someone, you —

- ☐ A. start a new argument with that person.
- ☐ B. stay angry and refuse to speak.
- ☐ C. walk away from that person for good.
- ☐ D. make up after a disagreement.

Q25 L.5.4

enabled

If a situation **enabled** people or animals, it —

- ☐ A. stopped them from doing something.
- ☐ B. gave them what they needed in order to do something.
- ☐ C. made them feel afraid.
- ☐ D. left them with nothing at all.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · WINTER BEES AND OTHER POEMS OF THE COLD

Q26 L.5.4

migrate

If animals **migrate**, they —

- ☐ A. stay in one place all year.
- ☐ B. dig deep underground.
- ☐ C. move from one area to live in another.
- ☐ D. change the color of their feathers.

Q27 L.5.4

aquatic

A plant or animal that is **aquatic** —

- ☐ A. lives in or around water.
- ☐ B. lives only in the desert.
- ☐ C. lives high in the mountains.
- ☐ D. lives deep inside caves.

Q28 L.5.4

formations

Formations are —

- ☐ A. the speeds at which things move.
- ☐ B. the distances between two places.
- ☐ C. the sounds that animals make.
- ☐ D. how things are arranged.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · WINTER BEES AND OTHER POEMS OF THE COLD (CONTINUED)

Q29 L.5.5 TRAP

random

If something is **random**, it —

- ☐ A. follows a careful, fixed plan.
- ☐ B. happens in the very same way each time.
- ☐ C. happens without a reason or pattern.
- ☐ D. is neatly placed in order.

Q30 L.5.4

scaled

If you **scaled** something, you —

- ☐ A. weighed it on a balance.
- ☐ B. climbed over it.
- ☐ C. painted it a new color.
- ☐ D. measured it with a ruler.

Q31 L.5.4

resume

If you **resume** something, you —

- ☐ A. start again after a break or pause.
- ☐ B. stop it for good.
- ☐ C. give it to someone else.
- ☐ D. write it down on paper.

Q32 L.5.4

grasp

If you **grasp** something, you —

- ☐ **A.** let it slip away.
- ☐ **B.** throw it far away.
- ☐ **C.** hold it firmly.
- ☐ **D.** drop it on the ground.

Q33 L.5.5 TRAP

resistant

If something is **resistant**, it is —

- ☐ **A.** easily damaged by anything around it.
- ☐ **B.** quickly broken down by the cold.
- ☐ **C.** soft and weak against harm.
- ☐ **D.** not harmed or affected by something else.



Worksheet B — Reading Comprehension

Module 10 · The Lives of Animals · Grade 5 · 32 Items

CCSS RI.5.1 · RI.5.2 · RI.5.3 · RI.5.5 · RI.5.6 · RI.5.8 · RL.5.1 · RL.5.2 · RL.5.3 · RL.5.5 · RL.5.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you remember from each selection to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

Selection 1 · Willie B.: A Story of Hope

NARRATIVE NONFICTION · NANCY ROE PIMM · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RI.5.2

What is "Willie B.: A Story of Hope" mostly about?

- ☐ A. A magazine article about hippos and tortoises.
- ☐ B. The true story of a gorilla who spent decades alone before learning to live with other gorillas.
- ☐ C. A video about how baby dolphins learn to survive.
- ☐ D. A poem about animals that survive the winter.

Q2 RI.5.3

According to the text, where did Willie B. live for almost three decades?

- ☐ A. In the jungles of Cameroon, with his troop.
- ☐ B. In a large outdoor rain-forest habitat.
- ☐ C. On a farm near the city of Atlanta.
- ☐ D. Alone in a small enclosure of concrete and glass at the zoo.

Q3 RI.5.3

According to the text, how did Charles Horton help Willie B.?

- ☐ A. As a keeper and friend, he played with Willie and coaxed him out into the new outdoor habitat.
- ☐ B. He captured Willie in Africa and brought him to the zoo.
- ☐ C. He decided that Willie should stay indoors forever.
- ☐ D. He taught Willie how to use sign language.

Q4 RI.5.1

According to the text, why did Dr. Terry Maple believe Willie B.'s life needed to change?

- ☐ **A.** Because Willie B. no longer drew a crowd of visitors.
- ☐ **B.** Because the zoo wanted to send Willie back to Africa.
- ☐ **C.** Because he knew that Willie's life of solitary confinement "was all wrong."
- ☐ **D.** Because Willie B. was too old to move outdoors.

Q5 RI.5.3

According to the text, what happened when Willie B. first went into the outdoor habitat?

- ☐ **A.** He ran straight to the other gorillas right away.
- ☐ **B.** He refused to leave and never went outside.
- ☐ **C.** He immediately climbed the tallest tree.
- ☐ **D.** For the first time in almost three decades, he saw the sky and grass and breathed fresh air.

Q6 RI.5.6

As narrative nonfiction, how does the author mainly tell Willie B.'s story?

- ☐ **A.** As a made-up tale with invented talking animals.
- ☐ **B.** As true, factual events told in time order, like a story, with real people and quotations.
- ☐ **C.** As a list of facts with no order at all.
- ☐ **D.** As a poem with rhyming lines.

Q7 RI.5.3

According to the text, how did Willie B.'s life change once he lived with other gorillas?

- ☐ **A.** He went back to living completely alone.
- ☐ **B.** He was returned to the wild in Africa.
- ☐ **C.** He joined a troop and fathered a new generation of gorillas, becoming a "family guy."
- ☐ **D.** He stopped eating and grew weaker.

Q8 RI.5.2

Which sentence BEST states a central idea of "Willie B.: A Story of Hope"?

- ☐ **A.** With time and care, an animal can recover from a hard life and change for the better.
- ☐ **B.** A gorilla is happiest when it is kept alone, away from other gorillas.
- ☐ **C.** A zoo can never be improved, no matter who is put in charge of it.
- ☐ **D.** An animal's life can never change once it has grown up.

Selection 2 · Dolphin Parenting

VIDEO (SCIENCE) · FROM NATIONAL GEOGRAPHIC · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RI.5.2

What is "Dolphin Parenting" mostly about?

- ☐ **A.** How a gorilla learned to live with a troop.
- ☐ **B.** How hippos and tortoises become friends.
- ☐ **C.** How bees survive a cold winter.
- ☐ **D.** How baby dolphins learn survival skills from their mothers.

Q10 RI.5.3

According to the video, how do baby dolphins learn from their mothers?

- ☐ **A.** By reading and following written directions.
- ☐ **B.** By copying the mothers' posture, movement, and actions.
- ☐ **C.** By being taught by a human trainer.
- ☐ **D.** By living completely apart from the mothers.

Q11 RI.5.1

According to the video, what is echolocation?

- ☐ **A.** A way dolphins use sound, like sonar, to find things.
- ☐ **B.** A way dolphins change the color of their skin.
- ☐ **C.** A kind of food that baby dolphins eat.
- ☐ **D.** A game that dolphins play with humans.

Q12 RI.5.3

According to the video, what is hydroplaning, as dolphins use it?

- ☐ **A.** A way of sleeping at the bottom of the sea.
- ☐ **B.** A way of singing to other dolphins.
- ☐ **C.** A technique, or way of moving, that dolphins learn to do.
- ☐ **D.** A way of building a nest.

Q13 RI.5.6

As a science video, how is the information mainly presented?

- ☐ **A.** As a made-up story with invented characters.
- ☐ **B.** Through a narrator explaining key ideas, supported by footage of animals in the wild.
- ☐ **C.** As a single photograph with no words.
- ☐ **D.** As a list of recipes.

Q14 RI.5.8

According to the video, why is it important for baby dolphins to learn these skills?

- ☐ **A.** So they can perform tricks for an audience.
- ☐ **B.** So they can win races against other dolphins.
- ☐ **C.** So they can stay close to humans for food.
- ☐ **D.** So they can fend for themselves and survive on their own.

Q15 RI.5.1

According to the video, how do sound and visual elements help the viewer?

- ☐ **A.** They make the topic harder to understand.
- ☐ **B.** They replace the narrator's explanations entirely.
- ☐ **C.** They show the behaviors the narrator describes, making the ideas clearer.
- ☐ **D.** They are only there for decoration.

Q16 RI.5.2

Which sentence BEST states the central message of "Dolphin Parenting"?

- ☐ **A.** Baby dolphins learn from their mothers how to thrive on their own.
- ☐ **B.** Dolphins are the fastest animals in the ocean.
- ☐ **C.** Dolphins are happiest when they live alone.
- ☐ **D.** Humans should teach dolphins how to hunt.

Selection 3 · Can We Be Friends?

MAGAZINE ARTICLE · ELLEN R. BRAAF · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RI.5.2

What is "Can We Be Friends?" mostly about?

- ☐ **A.** A gorilla who learns to live with a troop.
- ☐ **B.** How baby dolphins learn to hunt.
- ☐ **C.** How trees survive the cold of winter.
- ☐ **D.** Whether animals can truly be friends, and how they cooperate and form bonds.

Q18 RI.5.3

According to the text, what is the story of Owen and Mzee?

- ☐ **A.** Two dolphins that raced across the ocean.
- ☐ **B.** Two gorillas that lived in a zoo together.
- ☐ **C.** A baby hippo and a giant tortoise that became constant companions after a flood.
- ☐ **D.** Two scientists who studied bees.

Q19 RI.5.8

According to the text, why do many scientists hesitate to call animal relationships "friendship"?

- ☐ A. Because animals never spend time together.
- ☐ B. Because friendship is only about finding food.
- ☐ C. Because "friend" is a human word, and they are careful about using it for nonhuman animals.
- ☐ D. Because animals cannot live in groups.

Q20 RI.5.3

According to the text, how does playing together help animals?

- ☐ A. It helps forge social bonds that keep an animal within the safety of the group.
- ☐ B. It makes animals weaker and slower.
- ☐ C. It teaches animals to live completely alone.
- ☐ D. It has no effect on the group at all.

Q21 RI.5.5

How is the article organized to present its ideas?

- ☐ A. As a poem with stanzas.
- ☐ B. As a single paragraph with no breaks.
- ☐ C. As a set of diary entries by date.
- ☐ D. With headings such as "Kiss and Make Up" and "The Friendliest Animal" that group related facts and quotations.

Q22 RI.5.8

According to the text, what does Dr. de Waal's work with rhesus monkeys help show?

- ☐ A. That monkeys never argue with one another.
- ☐ B. That animals cannot remember each other.
- ☐ C. That reconciliation, making up after conflict, can be a learned social skill.
- ☐ D. That monkeys prefer to live alone.

Q23 RI.5.6

What is the author's main point in the section "The Friendliest Animal"?

- ☐ A. That animals are friendlier than humans.
- ☐ B. That the ability to form friendships has helped humans become very successful.
- ☐ C. That humans have no real friendships at all.
- ☐ D. That only hippos and tortoises can be friends.

Q24 **RI.5.2**

Which sentence BEST states a central idea of "Can We Be Friends?"?

- ☐ **A.** Hippos and tortoises are the only animals in the world that ever cooperate.
- ☐ **B.** Animals never help one another, and they always live and survive completely alone.
- ☐ **C.** Scientists fully agree that animals form the very same friendships that people do.
- ☐ **D.** Scientists debate whether animals are truly "friends," but many cooperate in ways that aid survival.

Selection 4 · Winter Bees and Other Poems of the Cold

POETRY · JOYCE SIDMAN (ILLUS. RICK ALLEN) · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 **RL.5.2**

What are the poems in "Winter Bees and Other Poems of the Cold" mostly about?

- ☐ **A.** How different animals and plants survive the cold of winter.
- ☐ **B.** How a gorilla learns to live in a zoo.
- ☐ **C.** How dolphins teach their young to hunt.
- ☐ **D.** Whether hippos and tortoises can be friends.

Q26 **RL.5.1**

In "Dream of the Tundra Swan," what do the swans do as winter approaches?

- ☐ **A.** They dig burrows in the frozen ground.
- ☐ **B.** They migrate, flying in V formations to a new place.
- ☐ **C.** They stay on the frozen tundra all winter.
- ☐ **D.** They build hives to keep warm.

Q27 **RL.5.5**

How is this selection structured as a multi-genre text?

- ☐ **A.** It is one long story told in chapters.
- ☐ **B.** Each poem is paired with a short informational paragraph about the same subject.
- ☐ **C.** It is a single poem with no other parts.
- ☐ **D.** It is a set of interviews with scientists.

Q28 **RL.5.3**

In "Winter Bees," how do the bees survive the cold, according to the poem?

- ☐ **A.** They fly south to a warmer place.
- ☐ **B.** They sleep alone in separate holes.
- ☐ **C.** They leave the hive empty until spring.
- ☐ **D.** They cluster together as one, working as a group — "Together, we are One."

Q29 RL.5.6

In "What Do the Trees Know?", what view of winter does the speaker share?

- ☐ **A.** That trees should fight against the wind.
- ☐ **B.** That winter is the same as summer.
- ☐ **C.** That trees survive by bending in the wind and letting go — "All we grasp we must let go."
- ☐ **D.** That trees grow fastest in the cold.

Q30 RL.5.3

In "Snowflake Wakes," how does the poet describe the snowflake?

- ☐ **A.** As if it were alive, following a random path through the air as it grows.
- ☐ **B.** As a heavy stone that drops straight down.
- ☐ **C.** As something that never moves at all.
- ☐ **D.** As a warm summer raindrop.

Q31 RL.5.2

Which sentence BEST states a theme of "Winter Bees and Other Poems of the Cold"?

- ☐ **A.** Winter is far too cold and harsh for any plant or animal to live through it.
- ☐ **B.** Every living thing prepares in its own way to survive winter, and there is strength in togetherness.
- ☐ **C.** Of all the dangers in nature, falling snow is the one that animals fear the most.
- ☐ **D.** Bees are the only living creatures that stay awake and active all winter long.

Q32 RL.5.6

How does pairing each poem with an informational paragraph shape the reader's understanding?

- ☐ **A.** It makes the poems harder to enjoy.
- ☐ **B.** It hides the meaning of the poems.
- ☐ **C.** It removes all feeling from the poems.
- ☐ **D.** It lets the reader feel the subject through the poem and also learn the science facts behind it.



Worksheet C — IB Critical Thinking

Module 10 · The Lives of Animals · Grade 5

IB PYP Key Concepts · DOK 2 – 4

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you learned from each selection to think more deeply about what we can learn from animals. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1 Change DOK 3

In "**Willie B.: A Story of Hope**," Willie B.'s life changes greatly. Show how his life was at the START and how it was at the END, then explain what helped him change.

HOW WILLIE B.'S LIFE CHANGED

WILLIE B. AT THE START

WILLIE B. AT THE END

What helped Willie B. change? Use one detail from the text in your answer.

Q2

Causation

DOK 3

In "**Dolphin Parenting**," baby dolphins learn to survive. Show one **SKILL** a baby dolphin learns and **HOW** it learns it, then explain why this learning matters.

CAUSE AND EFFECT · LEARNING TO SURVIVE

A SKILL THE BABY DOLPHIN LEARNS



HOW IT LEARNS THE SKILL

Why does this learning matter? Use one detail from the video.

Q3

Connection

DOK 3

In "**Can We Be Friends?**," the author asks whether animals can be friends. Show one REASON animals might be friends and one REASON scientists are careful with that word, then explain how cooperation helps animals.

TWO SIDES OF THE FRIENDSHIP QUESTION

A REASON FOR

how do animals act like friends?

A REASON TO BE CAREFUL

why do scientists hesitate?

HOW IT HELPS

how does cooperation help?

How does cooperating or playing together help animals survive? Use one detail from the text.

Q4

Form

DOK 3

In "**Winter Bees and Other Poems of the Cold**," the poet shows how living things survive winter. Show what ONE animal or plant DOES to survive and the FEELING the poem creates, then explain the poem's message.

HOW A POEM SHOWS SURVIVAL

WHAT THE ANIMAL OR PLANT DOES

A FEELING THE POEM CREATES

What is the poem's message about surviving winter? Explain using one detail from the text.

Essential Question: What can we learn about ourselves by observing and interacting with animals? Use ideas from TWO of the selections in this module to answer.

TWO-SELECTION SYNTHESIS

SELECTION 1 · TITLE

What did this selection show about animals, and what does it teach us about ourselves?

SELECTION 2 · TITLE

What did this selection show about animals, and what does it teach us about ourselves?

MY BIG IDEA



Worksheet D — MAP Practice

Module 10 · The Lives of Animals · Grade 5

MAP RIT 205 → 225 · 4 Mini-Passages × 5 Questions

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the selections in this workbook.

Passage 1 · The Elephant That Remembered

At a wildlife park in Kenya, the keepers tell a story about an elephant named Eleanor. Years ago, Eleanor was a young calf rescued after her family had moved away. A keeper named Daphne fed her every day and stayed close until the frightened calf calmed down. Slowly, a bond formed between them. Eleanor grew up strong and one day was set free to join a wild herd. The keepers were happy, but they also wondered if she would ever come back. Many years passed. Then, on a quiet morning, a huge elephant walked out of the trees and crossed the dusty field toward the camp. It was Eleanor. She stopped right in front of Daphne, reached out her trunk, and gently touched the woman she had not seen in years. The keepers could hardly believe it. Eleanor had remembered her old friend. Scientists say that elephants have excellent memories and can recognize animals and people they have not met for a long time. Watching Eleanor that day, the keepers learned something about loyalty and memory. People, too, hold on to the bonds they form, even after many years apart. Animals can remind us of what matters most in our own lives.

202 WORDS · LEXILE 620–710L · RIT 205–211

Q1 RIT 205 Lexile 620L Key Detail

Who took care of Eleanor when she was a young calf?

- ☐ A. A wild elephant herd.
- ☐ B. A group of tourists.
- ☐ C. A keeper named Daphne.
- ☐ D. A scientist from the city.

Q2 RIT 207 Lexile 645L Key Detail

What did Eleanor do when she returned to the camp?

- ☐ A. She reached out her trunk and gently touched Daphne.
- ☐ B. She ran away into the trees.
- ☐ C. She knocked over the camp tents.
- ☐ D. She refused to come near anyone.

Q3**RIT 208****Lexile 665L****Cause & Effect**

Why were the keepers able to believe the elephant was Eleanor?

- ☐ **A.** Because she was wearing a name tag.
- ☐ **B.** Because she was the smallest elephant there.
- ☐ **C.** Because another herd told them.
- ☐ **D.** Because she remembered Daphne and went straight to her.

Q4**RIT 210****Lexile 690L****Inference**

Why does the author tell this story about Eleanor?

- ☐ **A.** To explain how to train wild elephants.
- ☐ **B.** To show that animals can form lasting bonds, the way people do.
- ☐ **C.** To prove that elephants are dangerous.
- ☐ **D.** To describe the weather in Kenya.

Q5**RIT 211****Lexile 710L****Theme**

What is the main message, or theme, of this passage?

- ☐ **A.** An elephant will always forget anyone it has not seen for many years.
- ☐ **B.** Once an animal is set free, it can never feel a bond with a person again.
- ☐ **C.** Watching animals can remind us how much the bonds we form matter.
- ☐ **D.** A frightened young animal can never be calmed down by a person.

Passage 2 · Why Animals Live in Groups

Many animals spend their lives in groups rather than alone, and scientists have found good reasons why. One reason is safety. When animals stay together, more eyes can watch for danger, and a predator finds it harder to catch one animal in a crowd. A herd of zebras, for example, is much safer than a single zebra standing by itself. A second reason is help with finding food. Wolves that hunt as a pack can bring down prey that one wolf alone could never catch. Working together, they share the work and the meal. A third reason is raising young. In some animal families, older members help care for the babies while the parents search for food. This teamwork gives the young a better chance to grow up strong. Living in a group is not always easy. Animals must share space and food, and sometimes there is tension between them. Yet for most group animals, the benefits are greater than the costs. By cooperating, animals stay safer, eat better, and raise healthier young. In many ways, the reasons animals live in groups are a lot like the reasons people live in families and communities.

194 WORDS · LEXILE 760–860L · RIT 211–217

Q6 RIT 211 Lexile 760L Key Detail

According to the passage, how does living in a group help keep animals safe?

- ☐ A. More eyes can watch for danger, and a predator finds it harder to catch one animal in a crowd.
- ☐ B. The animals build tall walls around themselves.
- ☐ C. The group moves only at night.
- ☐ D. Each animal hides by itself.

Q7 RIT 213 Lexile 790L Key Detail

According to the passage, how do wolves benefit from hunting as a pack?

- ☐ A. They can sleep more during the day.
- ☐ B. They never have to share their food.
- ☐ C. They can travel to faraway countries.
- ☐ D. They can bring down prey that one wolf alone could never catch.

Q8 RIT 214 Lexile 810L Vocabulary

In the passage, the word "**tension**" means —

- ☐ A. a feeling of calm and rest.
- ☐ B. a feeling of stress between animals.
- ☐ C. a kind of food they share.
- ☐ D. a place where animals sleep.

Q9 RIT 215 Lexile 830L Author's Purpose

Why does the author compare animal groups to human families and communities at the end?

- ☐ A. To show that animals cooperate for many of the same reasons people do.
- ☐ B. To prove that animals are better than people.
- ☐ C. To explain how to start a zoo.
- ☐ D. To list the names of different animals.

Q10 RIT 217 Lexile 860L Main Idea

What is the main idea of "Why Animals Live in Groups"?

- ☐ A. A single zebra standing by itself is much safer than a whole herd of zebras.
- ☐ B. Living in a group is always easy, with no sharing of space or food required.
- ☐ C. Animals live in groups because cooperating helps them stay safe, eat better, and raise healthier young.
- ☐ D. Most animals prefer to live completely alone rather than share a group's costs.

Scientists who study animal behavior have learned that crows are among the cleverest birds in the world. In one famous experiment, a researcher placed a tasty treat at the bottom of a tall, narrow tube. The tube held a little water, but not enough for the treat to float within reach. Nearby, the scientist left a small pile of stones. A crow studied the problem for a moment. Then it began to drop stones, one by one, into the tube. As each stone sank, the water rose a little higher. The crow kept working until the water lifted the treat all the way to the top, where the bird could finally reach it. The crow had not been taught this trick. It had figured out, on its own, that adding stones would raise the water. Researchers were amazed. They explained that crows can plan ahead, use simple tools, and solve problems they have never seen before. By watching crows think their way through a puzzle, scientists understand more about how intelligence works in animals. They also learn something about people. Like crows, humans observe a problem, test an idea, and use what is around them to find a clever solution.

200 WORDS · LEXILE 820–910L · RIT 217–222

Q11 RIT 217 Lexile 820L Key Detail

According to the passage, what problem did the crow face?

- ☐ A. It was lost far from its nest.
- ☐ B. It could not fly over a tall wall.
- ☐ C. It had to escape from a cage.
- ☐ D. A treat sat at the bottom of a tube, too low in the water to reach.

Q12 RIT 218 Lexile 845L Sequence

What did the crow do to solve the problem?

- ☐ A. It tipped the whole tube over.
- ☐ B. It dropped stones into the tube, one by one, until the water rose.
- ☐ C. It called other crows to help.
- ☐ D. It waited for the scientist to hand over the treat.

Q13 RIT 219 Lexile 870L Cause & Effect

According to the passage, what happened as the crow dropped each stone?

- ☐ A. The water rose a little higher, lifting the treat toward the top.
- ☐ B. The tube cracked and the water leaked out.
- ☐ C. The treat sank deeper to the bottom.
- ☐ D. Nothing changed at all.

Q14 RIT 220 Lexile 890L Inference

Why were the researchers amazed by what the crow did?

- ☐ A. Because the crow had been carefully trained for years.
- ☐ B. Because the crow gave up quickly.
- ☐ C. Because the crow solved a problem it had never seen, with no one teaching it.
- ☐ D. Because the crow could speak words.

Q15 RIT 222 Lexile 910L Main Idea

What is the main idea of "The Crow That Solved a Puzzle"?

- ☐ A. The crow solved the puzzle only because a scientist had trained it for years.
- ☐ B. Studying clever crows helps scientists understand animal intelligence — and our own.
- ☐ C. The only thing crows are clever enough to do is lift a treat out of a tube.
- ☐ D. Crows are far too clever for scientists to learn anything by watching them.

Passage 4 · What Bees Teach Us About Teamwork

A single honeybee is a tiny creature that could not survive for long on its own. Yet together, thousands of bees form a colony that works like one large, well-organized body. Inside the hive, every bee has a job. Some bees clean and build the wax cells. Others guard the entrance against intruders. Young worker bees feed the growing young, while older workers fly out to gather nectar and pollen from flowers. When a forager bee finds a good patch of flowers, it returns to the hive and performs a special "waggle dance." The pattern of the dance tells the other bees the direction and distance to the food. In this way, information travels quickly through the colony, and the whole group benefits. Even in winter, the bees do not abandon one another. They cluster tightly together, shivering their muscles to make heat and keeping the queen warm at the center. Scientists who study bees marvel at how such small animals can accomplish so much by working together. The hive reminds us of an important lesson about ourselves: when people share information, divide the work, and look out for one another, a group can achieve far more than any single member could alone.

203 WORDS · LEXILE 900–1000L · RIT 219–225

Q16 RIT 219 Lexile 900L Key Detail

According to the passage, what is one job that bees do inside the hive?

- ☐ A. They paint the outside of the hive.
- ☐ B. They dig tunnels deep underground.
- ☐ C. They sleep all day and night.
- ☐ D. Some clean and build wax cells, while others guard the entrance.

Q17 RIT 220 Lexile 925L Key Detail

According to the passage, what does the "waggle dance" tell the other bees?

- ☐ A. The direction and distance to a good patch of flowers.
- ☐ B. The time the sun will set.
- ☐ C. Which bee is the strongest.
- ☐ D. How to build a new queen.

Q18 RIT 221 Lexile 950L Cause & Effect

According to the passage, how do bees stay warm in winter?

- ☐ **A.** They fly to a warmer country.
- ☐ **B.** They each sleep in a separate cell.
- ☐ **C.** They cluster tightly together and shiver their muscles to make heat.
- ☐ **D.** They light small fires in the hive.

Q19 RIT 223 Lexile 975L Author's Purpose

Why does the author describe the many jobs bees do in the hive?

- ☐ **A.** To prove that bees are dangerous.
- ☐ **B.** To show how the colony works together as one organized group.
- ☐ **C.** To explain how to keep bees as pets.
- ☐ **D.** To list the colors of flowers.

Q20 RIT 225 Lexile 1000L Main Idea

What is the main idea of "What Bees Teach Us About Teamwork"?

- ☐ **A.** By working together, a group of bees — like a group of people — can achieve far more than any one member alone.
- ☐ **B.** Each bee in the hive does every job on its own, without help from any other bee.
- ☐ **C.** A single bee, working alone, can build a whole hive and survive the winter by itself.
- ☐ **D.** The most important thing about a hive is that it makes sweet honey for people to eat.